

Propylene Glycol Diet



What is it?

People with allergic contact dermatitis can be so sensitive to their allergen that they must avoid skin exposure AND ingestion (eating) of the chemical. This type of allergy could cause dermatitis on the hands, face, around the mouth, or at the skin folds (armpits, groin). Some people may have dermatitis all over their bodies.

For some people allergic to propylene glycol, a diet low in propylene glycol can reduce the likelihood of skin reactions. The level of propylene glycol required to produce a response is unknown and can vary from patient to patient. A two-month trial of removing foods and beverages that contain propylene glycol is recommended.

Propylene glycol is used in the food industry as a solvent for food colors and flavoring agents. It is also used as a preservative, lubricant for food machinery and heat-transfer fluid for processing of foods.

The goal is avoidance of propylene glycol. In general, avoid mixed drinks, creamers, pre-packaged foods, fast food, certain medications and vitamins, canned beans and frozen vegetables.

References: *Dermatitis* 2012;23:248-257.

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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FOODS TO AVOID		FOODS ALLOWED	
BEVERAGES			
Alcoholic drink mixes, powdered drink mixes		Make alcoholic drinks from scratch.	
BEVERAGES (OTHER)			
Liquid water enhancer, coffee creamers, prepackaged coffees and cappuccinos, beverage mixers (example cream of coconut), shakes, root beer, smoothies		Use real cream. Izze sparkling juice, LaCroix sparkling water, San Pellegrino sparkling lemon or orange beverage, Martinelli’s apple juice, Mott’s apple juice, RW Knudsen juices, Indian Summer apple cider, Welch’s grape juice, Ocean Spray cranberry 100% juice, Naked Juice 100% juice smoothie are all ok. Read labels for other items.	
BREAD AND FLOUR			
Bagels, breadsticks, buns, rolls, flatbreads, pizza crust, biscuit and mix, stuffing, muffins, muffin mix, breads, dessert shells, cereal bars, cinnamon rolls		Nature’s Pride OvenClassics bread, Natural Ovens bagels, One Republic Artisan-Style pita are ok. Read labels for other items.	
BEANS AND VEGETABLES			
Goya brand canned beans, Bush’s baked beans, few frozen vegetables		Dried beans, La Preferida brand beans are ok.	
CONDIMENTS AND DRESSINGS			
Horseradish sauce, ketchup, mustard, salad dressings and toppings, spreads, dips, vinaigrette dressings, sauces, gravies		Hidden Valley, Marie’s, Brianna’s Home Style, Newman’s Own salad dressings, Heinz tomato ketchup, Heinz chili sauce, French’s and Mustard Girl mustards, Claussen kosher dill pickles, Boar’s Head horseradish sauce, Open Pit BBQ sauce, Smucker’s jelly or preserves, Tribe hummus, Tabasco sauce, Hellman’s Real mayonnaise, Shady Maple Farms Syrup Thick ‘N’ Rich organic syrup, Natures’ Promise Organics golden honey, Pompeian red wine vinegar are all ok. Make others from scratch. Read labels for other items.	
DAIRY			
Cream cheese, yogurt, oil spreads, sour cream, dips, cheese, whipped cream		Daisy sour cream or cottage cheese, Philadelphia original cream cheese, Yoplait original yogurt, Dean’s whipping cream, Land O’Lakes butter, Kraft cheese are all ok. Read labels for other items.	

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FOODS TO AVOID		FOODS ALLOWED	
DESSERTS AND SNACKS			
Cakes, cake mixes, dessert toppings, wafers, chocolate, candy, cheesecake, cookies, pudding, mousse, shortcake, ice cream, ice cream cakes, pies, sorbets, cream pies, brownie and brownie mix, popcorn, French fried onion, potato sticks, dessert toppings		Jell-O pudding cups, Häagen-Dazs ice cream, Dove Silky Smooth chocolates, Dove ice cream bars, Comstock More Fruit pie filling or toppings, Hostess cherry and apple pie, Betty Crocker brownie mixes, Popcom Indiana Kettlecorn All Natural, Edy’s fruit bars are all ok. Read labels for other items.	
MEATS			
Bacon, meat glaze, pre-marinated meats (examples pre-marinated turkey breast, ham)		Oscar Mayer bacon, Bob Evans sausage, Oscar Mayer Deli Fresh turkey, ham or chicken, Buddig packaged meats, Jimmy Dean all-natural pork sausage, Vienna beef franks or Polish sausage are all ok. Read labels for other items.	
PREPACKAGED MEALS			
Breakfast bars, yogurt bars, Pop-Tart, breakfast pastries, toaster strudel, prepackaged breakfast sandwiches. Frozen microwave meals, prepackaged meals, frozen pizza, prepackaged salads, prepackaged sandwiches		Nabisco BelVita breakfast biscuits, Fiber One chewy bars, Kellogg’s Pop-Tarts, Kashi TLC Soft Baked cereal bars are ok. Amy’s brand frozen meals, Lean Cuisine frozen meals, Stouffer’s frozen meals are all ok. Read labels for other items.	
SEAFOOD			
Salmon and crab cake mixes		Blue Star crab meat is ok. Read labels for other items.	
SOUPS			
Bouillon, dried soup mixes		Some Progresso brand canned soups, Swanson chicken and beef broth are ok. Make soup from scratch or buy canned soup. Read labels for other items.	
SPICES, SEASONINGS, AND COOKING PRODUCTS			
Food coloring and artificial flavor extracts (for example: butter flavor, vanilla extract)		Land O’Lakes butter is ok. Use real butter. Use natural flavors. Avoid food coloring.	
MEDICATIONS, VITAMINS, AND SUPPLEMENTS			
Whey powder, medications with coated tablets or liquid form, chewables, lozenges, liquid antacids		Uncoated pills are ok. Read labels.	
OTHER			
All fast foods			

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